Cairngorm Circuit

Seb Wong Orienteering Tours · Cairngorms, United Kingdom · Grades 9 – 12

ETI360

TRIP TYPE	PHYSICAL DEMAND	ACCOMMODATION	BEST SEASON	COST TIER	YEAR GROUP
Expedition & Navigation	Challenging (Grade B)	Hostel / Bunkhouse	May – September	Request Quote	Grades 9 – 12

TRIP OVERVIEW

A six-day expedition across Britain's highest plateau, designed to build real map-and-compass competence on some of the UK's most demanding high-level terrain. Students carry full OS 1:25,000 maps and compasses only — no GPS in the field — and rotate navigator roles in teams of three. Days progress from glen-level point-to-point legs through the Ryvoan Pass score event to a full summit navigation of Cairngorm (1,245 m), a 27 km Lairig Ghru traverse, and a night score event in Abernethy Forest. Mountain rescue radio protocol, advanced contour interpretation, and weather-driven go/no-go decisions are taught and assessed throughout.

DAY-BY-DAY HIGHLIGHTS

ARRIVAL
Inverness to Aviemore

- Coach transfer from Inverness Airport
- Kit + compass calibration sessions
- Mountain rescue radio protocol
- Day 1 route planning brief

DAY 1
Ryvoan Pass Score Event

- 16 km glen-level score event
- Up to 10 checkpoints, 4-hour window
- Teams choose own route between controls
- GPS-track field debrief at Glenmore

DAY 2
Cairngorm Summit (1,245 m)

- 14 km, 700 m ascent to the plateau
- Compass bearing navigation in cloud
- Teams within 50 m of each checkpoint
- Student-chosen descent route

DAY 3
Lairig Ghru Traverse

- 27 km through the Lairig Ghru pass
- Mandatory navigator rotation
- Regroups at Lurcher's Crag + Pools of Dee
- Finish in Braemar, bunkhouse overnight

DAY 4
Night Score Event

- Return coach to Aviemore base
- Headtorch + night-nav training
- 3-hour Abernethy Forest score event
- Radio check-ins every 30 minutes

DEPARTURE
Debrief to Inverness

- Route-card presentations (one per student)
- Portfolio submission + certificates
- Final lunch in Aviemore
- Coach to Inverness Airport (16:00+)

Seb Wong Orienteering Tours

Navigation-first expedition provider specialising in British and European high-ground programmes. School-audience focus, compass-and-map methodology, GPS-track debrief as standard.

sebwongtours.com

SWOT T1 · SCO-HL · Cairngorm Circuit Page 1 of 3

T1 · SCO-HL · Grade B

Cairngorm Circuit

Moorland navigation, mountain weather, and Britain's highest plateau.

Scottish Highlands, UK · Inverness Airport (INV)

PROGRAMME OVERVIEW

Duration	6 Days / 5 Nights	Grade	B — Challenging
Group Size	Max 18 Students (Grades 9–12)	Best Season	May – September
Arrival Airport	Inverness (INV) — in and out	Programme Type	High School Expedition

PROGRAMME DESCRIPTION

The Cairngorm Circuit places students on some of the UK's most demanding high-level terrain. Over six days, teams rotate through increasingly complex navigation challenges: from glen-level point-to-point legs on Day 1 to full summit route-choice problems on Day 4.

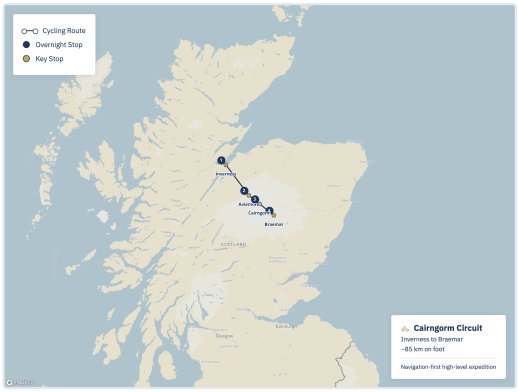
Students carry full OS 1:25,000 maps and compasses only — no GPS in the field. Groups of three operate with rotating navigator roles. Evening debrief sessions use GPS track overlays to compare each team's actual route with their planned route.

Mountain rescue radio protocol is taught and practised on Day 1 and assessed on Day 5. Night navigation is introduced on Day 5 under controlled conditions.

INCLUDED IN THIS PROGRAMME

✓ All field navigation sessions with SWOT-qualified instructors ✓ All meals (breakfast, lunch, dinner) as specified ✓ All accommodation (hostel, guesthouse, or mountain hut) ✓ All maps and navigation equipment ✓ Emergency medical kit and radio communications ✓ GPS track overlays for daily debrief sessions ✓ Pre-departure teacher resource pack ✓ Post-trip debrief guide and route portfolio

LOCATION



KEY DETAILS

Duration	6 days / 5 nights
Est. Cost	$2,800 – $3,600
Group Size	Max 18
Daily Distance	14–27 km on foot
Flights	Not included
Ratio	Max 18 : 2 SWOT staff

INCLUDED

- SWOT-qualified navigation instructors
- All meals (breakfast, lunch, dinner)
- Hostel / bunkhouse accommodation
- OS 1:25,000 maps + compasses
- Emergency medical kit + radio comms
- GPS track overlays for debrief
- Pre-departure teacher resource pack

NOT INCLUDED

- International flights
- Travel insurance
- Personal spending

This document summarises information provided by the trip operator. ETI360 has not independently verified or endorsed this content. Schools should conduct their